Barbara Poppe | Selected Quotes

Personal reference for the Chico conversation • October 15, 2026

Homelessness is a policy choice

“Homelessness is a choice, but it’s the policy choice that we’ve made. It’s not the choice of any of the individuals.”

Interview timestamp: 15:06–15:15

“We know how to house every single person and we could do it, but we choose not to.”

Interview timestamp: 17:17–17:30

“The tragedy is that we do not invest at scale in the solutions.”

Interview timestamp: 16:47–17:01

“The solution is we need to invest in housing as a basic human right and actually bring it to scale.”

Interview timestamp: 17:36–17:53

Enforcement and punishment

“We can’t arrest our way out of poverty. Never, never, never could, never will.”

Interview timestamp: 31:05–31:14

“It’s not a question of we can’t afford to do it. It’s ... we can’t afford not to.”

Interview timestamp: 34:04–34:19

“This country has a long history of punishing poor people.”

Interview timestamp: 33:15–33:24

Housing systems, lived experience, and practical action

“We shouldn’t be about managing homelessness. We really needed to have a plan to end homelessness.”

Interview timestamp: 6:11–6:28

“You’re never going to be successful if you don’t ... partner with the folks who are out there.”

Interview timestamp: 9:29–9:44

“We should always be talking to people who are using the programs.”

Interview timestamp: 11:17–11:32

“They’ll be paid at a consultant rate because they’re highly valued.”

Interview timestamp: 12:05–12:22

“We need to continue to uplift that ... we can make different choices and it’ll be better for all of us.”

Interview timestamp: 39:07–39:24

Narrative and community response

“I have to believe in the goodness of people at large ... to really want this to be a better country than it currently is.”

Interview timestamp: 33:49–34:04

“It does take people of goodwill to stand up and to say no.”

Interview timestamp: 34:04–34:19

“We need to uplift the nonprofit sector, the people doing the good work.”

Interview timestamp: 38:19–38:36

Source and quotation notes. Excerpts from Barbara Poppe’s conversation with Mark Horvath on *Homeless Unfiltered* (Invisible People), based on the transcript provided for this meeting. Timestamps identify approximate positions in the interview. Ellipses indicate material omitted; minor transcript punctuation and disfluencies have been smoothed. The interview opening montage repeats some statements; the main-interview timestamp is used. This sheet attributes only Barbara’s remarks to her, not Mark’s questions or comments. Confirm against the audio before formal publication.